A-A-20130
June 17, 1985

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CHICKEN FILLETS, CHUNKED AND FORMED, BREADED, PRECOOKED, FROZEN

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Military Specification MIL-C-44119 (GL),Chicken Fillet, Chunked and Formed,Breaded, Precooked, Frozen.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers frozen, precooked, breaded, chunked and formed, chicken fillets, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient characteristics.

The frozen, precooked, breaded, chunked and formed chicken fillets shall conform to the following types as specified in the contract or purchase order.

Type I - 3 ounce round fillet
Type II - 5 ounce round fillet
Type III - 0.5 ounce fillet nugget

A. Ingredients. The ingredients used to prepare the chicken fillets shall be chicken, sodium tripolyphosphate and batter/breading ingredients. No skin is permitted.

Chicken. Only breast meat with rib meat and other white (first and second portion wing and scapula) chicken meat in natural proportions shall be used for this product. The chickens from which the breast with rib meat and other white meat are derived shall be fresh chilled broiler/fryers meeting the requirements of U.S. Grade A for fleshing and fat cover. No previously frozen chicken meat and no previously cooked chicken meat may be used in this product. The chicken may be offered as carcasses or as bone-in parts or boneless meat. Mechanically deboned (comminuted) meat shall be excluded from use in this product.

Sodium tripolyphosphate. Sodium tripolyphosphate shall be Food Grade not to exceed the levels permitted by the Poultry Products Inspection Regulations (9 CFR 381) of the U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA).

FSC 8905

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Batter/breading ingredients. Only commercially prepared batter/breading ingredients (not artificially colored) commonly used for the type of product specified shall be permitted.

B. Preparation and processing. All preparation and processing described below shall occur subsequent to the date of award. The poultry component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under the Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. Chicken which has been shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA Poultry Products Grading Certificate, certifying class, condition, and processing date.

Preparation of chicken. If presented as carcasses or bone-in parts, the chicken shall be skinned and raw boned. The boned and trimmed chicken meat may be used as removed from the carcass or may be reduced in size by passing the chicken meat once through a kidney plate with openings of 2-1/2 inches in the least dimension. Fine grinding (less than dimensions shown), chopping (silent cutter, hydroflaker), or flake cutting of the chicken meat is not permitted.

Preparation of breaded chicken fillets:

Mixing and forming. The chicken meat shall be mixed with the sodium tripolyphosphate in accordance with the Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. The mixed product shall be mechanically formed to comply with the product requirements. The thickness of the plate used to form the fillets shall be approximately 3/8 inch.

Batter/breading. The formed chicken fillets shall be uniformly coated with batter and breading. All batter and breading shall be applied by machine. Combined batter and breading shall not exceed 25 percent by weight of the uncooked breaded fillet weight.

Cooking. The breaded fillets shall be cooked by any method or combination of methods allowed by the Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. An internal product temperature of 160°F shall be obtained during cooking.

Freezing. The cooked breaded fillets shall be frozen by an individually quick frozen method in accordance with the Poultry Products Inspection Regulations so that individual fillets do not stick together after freezing. The frozen, cooked, breaded fillets shall be held at 0°F or below after freezing. The internal product temperature shall not exceed 0°F at the time of shipment and delivery.

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Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product within the commercial marketplace. The delivered product shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Inspection Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Quality assurance.

When required in the contract or purchase order, the quality assurance for the chicken fillets shall be determined by the Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service USDA in accordance with USDA procedures. The product shall be examined and/or tested for conformance to the product requirements in this CID and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation and in accordance with the requirements in the applicable regulations.

The cooked breaded fillets, as the last step prior to packaging, will be examined by a metal detection device capable of detecting metals that may be present in the product. The examination shall be by (a) a metal detection device operating properly as measured by a detection test strip containing a 440 stainless steel sphere measuring exactly 1.50 mm (0.0591 inch) diameter, (b) presenting the fillets in their smallest dimension (thickness) within the detection field of the device, and (c) procedures appropriate for the depth of the detection field of the device and the sensitivity of the device. The metal detection device shall be one approved by the Food Safety and Inspection Service (FSIS) of the USDA. The contractor will provide the prescribed detection test strip for testing the metal detection device under the supervision of USDA. The frequency of testing will be according to the Poultry Division's online acceptable quality level procedure. These guidelines do not relieve the contractor of its responsibility to provide a safe product.

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Any product suspected of containing or found to contain metal will be handled according to and the disposition of the product determined by FSIS procedures.

Product requirements. The product shall comply with the following requirements:

1. There shall be no foreign material (for example: dirt, hair, grease, insect parts, metal).

2. There shall be no foreign odors or flavors (for example: burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, moldy).

3. There shall be no foreign color(s).

4. Piece size of boneless chicken meat presented for processing shall be typical for boned and trimmed chicken meat as removed from the carcass. The boneless chicken meat presented for processing shall not have been previously mechanically reduced in size.

5. The chicken meat shall have no bone, cartilage, ligaments, tendons, coarse connective tissue, blood clots, skin, or bruised or discolored meat exceeding 1/4 inch in any dimension.

6. Combined batter and breading shall not exceed 25 percent by weight of the uncooked breaded fillet weight.

7. The cooked, breaded fillets shall not be fractured (separated into two or more separate pieces).

8. There shall be not more than one area devoid of batter/breading greater than 1/2 inch in any dimension for types I and II or 1/4 inch in any dimension for type III.

9. After cooking, there shall be no lumps (outcropping of breading on the surface of a fillet) greater than 1/4 inch in depth.

10. After cooking, there shall be no coating ridge (excess breading which projects at the edge of a fillet) greater than 1/2 inch in any dimension.

11. After cooking, there shall be no burnt (scorched) area on a fillet greater than 1/4 inch in any dimension.

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12. Weight of the cooked, breaded fillets shall be:

Type I - Not less than 3.0 ounces
Type II - Not less than 5.0 ounces
Type III - Not less than 0.5 ounce

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The chicken fillets shall be preserved, packaged, packed, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the contract or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurements.

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer:

A. Commercial packing for Types I and II. Forty pounds of product shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container in accordance with good commercial practice. The shipping container shall be lined with a plastic bag of sufficient size to line the interior of the box completely and shall overlap not less than 5 inches along the center of the longer axis after the bag is folded down over the packed product. The product shall be arranged in layers with each layer no thicker than the thickness of one fillet. Each layer of product shall be separated from each adjacent layer with a single sheet of polyethylene, not less than 1 inch longer than the length and width of the container. In addition, a sheet of polyethylene shall be placed between the inside bottom of the bag and the first layer and another placed on top of the top layer packed in the box.

B. Export packing for Types I and II. Forty pounds of product shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container constructed and reinforced in accordance with Style FTC, Grade W5c or W5s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a wax-impregnated fiberboard box conforming to Style RSC, Class I, Type SWCF1, Grade 200 of PPP-B-1163. The shipping container shall be lined with a plastic bag of sufficient size to line the interior of the box completely and shall overlap not less than 5 inches along the center of the longer axis after the bag is folded down over the packed product. The product shall be arranged in layers with each layer no thicker than the thickness of one fillet. Each layer of product shall be separated from each adjacent layer with a single sheet of polyethylene, not less than 1 inch

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longer than the length and width of the container. In addition, a sheet of polyethylene shall be placed between the inside bottom of the bag and the first layer and another placed on top of the top layer packed in the box. The polyethylene film for the bag and the separator material shall be of 0.0015 inch minimum thickness conforming to class 2 of L-P-378. Closure of the wax impregnated box shall be with hot-melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The wax-impregnated box shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Reinforcement of PPP-B-636 and PPP-B-1163 boxes shall be restricted to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. All reinforcing bands shall be uncolored or of a color which contrasts with black.

C. Commercial packaging for Type III. Not more than 10 pounds of product shall be packaged into a commercial package. The package shall afford adequate protection against deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first consuming activity.

D. Commercial packing for Type III. Not more than 40 pounds of Type III product commercially packaged shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container. The shipping container shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification, or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable, except that the closure of the fiberboard boxes shall be in accordance with Method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

E. Export packaging for Type III. Not more than 10 pounds of product shall be packaged into a paperboard carton of the type commercially used for packaging this product; provided it is fabricated from pulp and is new, clean, and does not impart an odor, flavor, or color to the product. The interior of the carton shall be coated or impregnated with wax or polyethylene. Cartons that are not self-locking shall be sealed in accordance with good commercial practice. Alternatively, 10 pounds of Type III chicken fillets shall be packaged in a waxed carton made of bending chipboard not less than 0.002 inch thick. The carton shall be completely lined with bleached, semi-bleached, or unbleached Kraft or sulfite paper or vegetable parchment having a minimum basis weight of 26 pounds per ream (24 by 36-500). The paper or parchment shall be wet waxed on both sides with not less than 9 pounds per ream (24 by 36-500) of a fully-refined paraffin wax. Alternatively, the carton shall be lined with polyethylene film 0.0015 inch thick.

F. Export packing for Type III. Not more than 40 pounds of Type III product export packaged shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container. The shipping container shall be a fiberboard box, constructed, closed and

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reinforced in accordance with Style RSC, Grade V3c, V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a wax-impregnated fiberboard box constructed in accordance with Style RSC, Class I, Type SWCF II, Grade 275 of PPP-B-1163. Closure of the wax-impregnated box shall be with hot-melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The wax-impregnated box shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Reinforcement of PPP-B-636 and PPP-B-1163 boxes shall be restricted to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. All reinforcing bands shall be uncolored or of a color which contrasts with black.

G. Labeling (commercial and export). Labeling of cartons shall be in accordance with commercial practice and be in compliance with Poultry Products Inspection Regulations..

H. Marking (commercial and export). Commercial markings for shipping containers are acceptable provided the following information is included:

National Stock Number
Item Description
Quantity, Unit of Issue
Date of Packaging (Month/Year)
Contract Number
Inspection/Test Date
Name, Address, and Zip Code of Contractor

In addition, the following precautionary marking shall appear in letters not less than 1 inch high on top of each container:

PERISHABLE - KEEP FROZEN
(0°F OR BELOW)

Notes.

Sources of documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
1616 P Street, NW
Washington, DC 20036

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Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1106
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Sources of governmental documents are as follows:

The Poultry Products Inspection Regulations are contained in 9 CFR Part 200 to end. These regulations may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID and referenced Federal Specifications (PPP-B-636, PPP-B-1163, and L-P-378) from:

General Services Administration
Specification Unit (WFSIS)
7th and D Streets, SW, Room 6039
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit request for copies of this CID and referenced Federal Specifications (PPP-B-636, PPP-B-1163, and L-P-378) to:

Naval Publications and Forms Center
5801 Tabor Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19120

Comments and suggestions.

Comments and suggestions regarding this CID may be submitted to :

U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center
ATTN: STRNC-ES
Natick, MA 01760-5014

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

USDA - MRD

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project No. 8905-B020

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